Assignment 1 – Context Moat with Claude AI

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Project: CRM Dashboard Experience Design

Output 1: Prompt with no context

Output 1: No Context

UX Strategy

The core strategy should center on reducing cognitive load for time-pressed users who move between customer records constantly. Prioritize a single-pane workflow where sales reps and support agents can see context (customer history, open tasks, recent interactions) without navigating away from what they're doing. Use progressive disclosure — show summary data by default, let users drill into detail on demand. Establish a consistent visual hierarchy across the CRM so leads, tasks, and conversations all follow the same interaction patterns, reducing the learning curve when switching between modules.

User Flow Recommendations

- **Sales rep flow:** Dashboard → Lead list → Lead detail → Log interaction/Update stage → Set follow-up task → Confirmation
- **Support agent flow:** Dashboard → Active conversations → Customer profile → Activity timeline → Resolve/Escalate → Add notes
- **Manager flow:** Dashboard → Team pipeline overview → Drill into rep performance → Reassign tasks/leads → Reporting view

Keep each flow to 3–4 taps/clicks maximum from dashboard to task completion. Use a persistent bottom or side navigation for the core modules (Leads, Tasks, Conversations, Reports) so users never lose their place.

Dashboard Structure

- Top: key metrics (open leads, pending follow-ups, active conversations) as scannable cards
- Middle: prioritized task list, sorted by urgency/due date
- Bottom or secondary tab: pipeline visualization (kanban-style stages)
- Persistent notification bell/icon with badge count

Use role-based dashboard variants — a manager's dashboard should surface team-wide metrics, while a rep's dashboard focuses on their personal queue.

Feature Prioritization

Must-have (MVP):

- Lead management, task assignment, activity timeline, notifications

Should-have (Phase 2):

- Pipeline visualization, support conversation threading

Nice-to-have (Phase 3):

- Advanced reporting, customization, integrations

Mobile Usability Suggestions

- Thumb-friendly tap targets (minimum 44x44px)
- Bottom navigation bar for core sections
- Swipe gestures for quick actions (e.g., swipe to mark task complete)
- Collapsible cards to manage information density on small screens
- Offline-friendly caching for recently viewed records

Onboarding Recommendations

- Role-based onboarding — different first-run experience for reps vs. managers vs. support agents
- Interactive walkthrough highlighting the 3 core actions (create lead, log interaction, set follow-up)
- Empty states with clear calls-to-action rather than blank screens

UI/UX Improvement Opportunities

- Use color coding consistently for pipeline stages and task urgency
- Reduce form fields wherever possible; use smart defaults and auto-fill
- Real-time sync indicators so users trust data is current
- Search should be globally accessible, not buried in a menu

Observation:

The first output followed common global SaaS and enterprise CRM patterns. The recommendations focused more on advanced dashboard structures, kanban-style pipeline visualization, and feature-rich interactions while assuming stable internet connectivity and technically confident users.

Output 2: Same prompt with context

Output 2: With Context

UX Strategy

Optimize for speed and reliability over visual sophistication. Since users are on low-to-mid Android devices with inconsistent connectivity, the strategy should prioritize a lightweight, low-bandwidth interface with aggressive local caching — users need to see their leads and follow-ups even on a weak signal. Interaction patterns should mirror what users already trust from bKash and similar local apps: large tap targets, single-column layouts, minimal steps to complete an action. Since many users are not highly tech-savvy, avoid CRM jargon (no "pipeline stages" or "lead scoring" without plain-language labels) and favor familiar, task-oriented language. Bangla/English mixing should be supported natively in text fields, not treated as an edge case.

User Flow Recommendations

- **Sales rep flow:** Home (today's follow-ups) → Tap lead → Quick-update status (single tap/dropdown, not a form) → Set next reminder → Done. Target 2–3 taps total, since reps are moving between calls/visits.
- **Support agent flow:** Home (active conversations, sorted by wait time) → Tap conversation → Customer history (collapsed by default, one tap to expand) → Reply/resolve → Done.
- **Manager flow:** Home (team snapshot: pending follow-ups, unresolved conversations, flagged issues) → Tap a metric to see who's behind → Reassign with one tap. No separate "reporting module" — visibility should be immediate, not a drill-down exercise.

Avoid multi-step wizards. Every flow should assume the user may lose connection mid-task, so each step should auto-save independently rather than requiring a final "submit."

Dashboard Structure

- Single scrollable home screen, not a multi-tab dashboard — reduces navigation confusion for less tech-savvy users
- Top: 2–3 large, plain-language status cards ("5 follow-ups today," "3 waiting replies") — no charts or graphs
- Middle: prioritized action list (what needs attention right now), not a visual pipeline board
- Bottom: simple icon-based navigation (Home, Leads, Conversations, Notifications) — mirrors bKash-style bottom nav
- Skip the kanban-style pipeline visualization entirely for reps/agents; reserve any visual pipeline view for managers only, and keep it simple (a horizontal count bar, not a drag-and-drop board)

Feature Prioritization

Must-have (MVP):

- Lead list with quick-update, follow-up reminders, customer activity timeline (text-based, not visual timeline), basic notifications

Should-have (Phase 2):

- Support conversation threading, manager team snapshot view

De-prioritize or simplify heavily:

- Advanced pipeline visualization, customization, integrations, detailed analytics/reporting — these add complexity without matching what this team actually needs day-to-day

Mobile Usability Suggestions

- No animations over 150ms — anything longer will feel laggy on common devices here
- Avoid heavy images/large data loads on initial screen load; paginate or lazy-load customer lists
- Design for one-handed use — reps are often on the move, possibly standing
- Text fields must handle mixed Bangla/English input cleanly (font rendering, input method compatibility)
- Build in visible offline states ("Saved — will sync when online") rather than silent failures or spinners
- Avoid relying on gestures like swipe-to-action as the *only* way to perform a task — not all users will discover it; pair gestures with visible buttons

Onboarding Recommendations

- Skip elaborate walkthroughs; instead use inline hints on first use of each screen ("Tap here to update a lead")
- Model onboarding after bKash-style simplicity: 1–2 screens max, focused on "here's how you update a lead" and "here's how you see your follow-ups" — not a full feature tour
- Avoid text-heavy onboarding; users respond better to seeing the action than reading about it

Observation:

After adding Bangladesh-specific user behavior, device limitations, workflow priorities, and operational realities, the recommendations became significantly more lightweight, mobile-first, operationally focused, and behavior-aware. The output prioritized usability, reminders, offline handling, and familiar interaction patterns over visually complex SaaS experiences.

What changed between without context and with context

- Claude initially assumed enterprise-style CRM usage with advanced dashboard patterns. After I added operational and user-behavior context, the recommendations became simpler and more task-focused.
- The generic output assumed stable internet connectivity and technically confident users. After I added low-end Android and inconsistent network constraints, Claude introduced lightweight interactions and offline-friendly behavior.
- Without context, the onboarding and navigation followed common global SaaS patterns. After adding familiar local behavior references like bKash-style simplicity, the UX became more direct and easier for non-technical users.
- The contextual version prioritized reminders, quick follow-ups, customer history visibility, and one-handed usability because I added real workflow behavior from sales and support teams.

My Context Moat

Working on CRM and operational SaaS products taught me that real user behavior is very different from the assumptions most AI-generated UX follows. In real workflows, sales and support teams often prioritize speed, quick follow-ups, and customer history visibility over visually complex dashboards or advanced features. I've also seen how many users access these platforms from low to mid-range Android devices while working in fast-paced environments with inconsistent internet connectivity. These practical realities and workflow behaviors are things Claude cannot naturally understand unless someone with real product experience intentionally provides that context.